Tavy Bridge

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

news



EDITION TWO JUNE 2002



Hello, my name is Kaye Sene and I am the new *Community Renewal Assistant*. I have worked in housing for over 12 years and I am really pleased to be part of the Community Renewal Team. I am really enthusiastic about the projects I am working on at the moment in particular the graffiti wall and the BMX skateboard park. I am looking forward to meeting local residents and young people during the course of these projects.

If you would like more information on these projects or have some ideas you would like to discuss please give me a ring on 020 8320 3462.

Look forward to meeting you soon!

Kaye Sene
Community Renewal Assistant

Tavy Bridge Project update

Consultation

Over the last few months, we have been taking your suggestions and ideas on what you want to see at the new Tavy Bridge.

Since the Tavy Bridge survey was carried out last summer, a Focus Group consisting of local people has been established. This group has met regularly and has identified some of the top priority areas, and discussed how the new Tavy Bridge might look and feel like to live in. The group will be planning more consultation events as the summer progresses, so watch this space or contact Claire Irvine on the number below for more information.

Community Safety

Gallions Housing Association and the Tavy Bridge Focus Group have been given £114,750 from the Single Regeneration Budget regeneration programme to make some immediate improvements in community safety in the area: the lighting, security and the environment in and around Tavy Bridge with be dealt with first.

What happens next?

There is now a lot of planning work to be done! We need you, the Tavy Bridge community, to help make sure your needs are being addressed right through the project, so Community Renewal staff will be working with local people and agencies to start up some community-led schemes alongside the building work. We also need to look at how the whole project will be managed and make sure that the money is in place.

We will continue to talk to people such as the library and health centre staff, community groups and the shopkeepers to make sure that the proposals work for everyone in Tavy Bridge.

As you can see, we have started the process but it is by no means over and we will be talking to many people throughout the life of the project. Gallions is committed to the regeneration of Tavy Bridge and is keen to hear from anyone who would like further information, or who has ideas about improvements to the area.

Please contact Claire Irvine, Community Renewal Manager on **020 8320 3494** or **cirvine@gallionsha.co.uk**

Check out the Gallions website for more info about Tavy Bridge:

www.gallionsha.co.uk

FUN DAY

We are planning a Tavy Bridge Fun Day for 27th July, 12 – 4pm. With plenty of fun and games for the children, a BBQ, and for the adults, light music! If you have any comments or ideas you would like us to consider please contact Kaye Sene on 020 8320 3462.

Check out our website for further details



BMX skateboard park is on its way!

The process for the development of a BMX skateboard park is underway. We would like to talk to local young people to get ideas on the type of park and equipment needed.

If you are interested in this project please contact Kaye Sene on 020 8320 3462 or check out our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk

Library

The Thamesmead Library in Binsey Walk will be undergoing some refurbishment works within the next month. Work will be carried out to the roof and once this is completed the library will undergo refurbishment .

For further information on closure of the library please phone 020 8310 9944.

As usual, the Library will be carrying out various summer activities such as 'Book Worm'. Children will be given a reading card and encouraged to read several books. Those who complete their cards will receive free badges, vouchers, certificates and free videos. So pop along and join in the fun!

Book Worm begins on 22nd July until 31st August and children of all ages are welcome.

The library has an Open Learning Assistant who is employed for 20 hours a week. You can phone up and book a 1 hour free session to gain computer and internet training.
Free training is available to everyone as long as you are a member of the library.

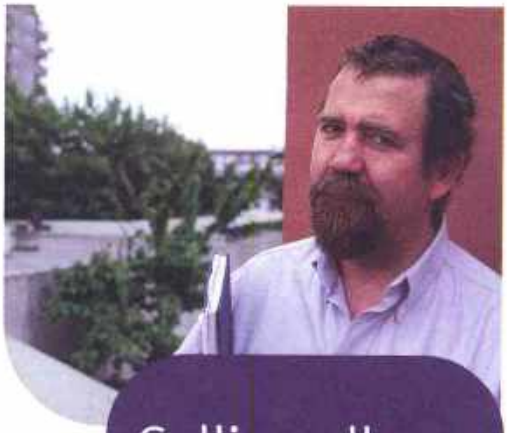
For information on any of the events please phone 020 8310 9944 and have a chat to the friendly staff at the library.

Graffiti Wall

Gallions is looking into a pilot scheme to create a legal graffiti wall for the use of the local community. It is hoped that the scheme will encourage local artists to display their work in a designated and safe environment. The consultation process with young people from the local Youth Awareness Programme (YAP) is underway. If you are interested in this project please contact Kaye Sene on 020 8320 3462.

"A graffiti wall has been a long anticipated project and I am confident that it would be a positive and well accepted initiative into the area" Pete Fallon YAP project worker





Calling all Tavy and Binsey residents...

Are you interested in creating a Residents Association, TAB for short perhaps?

My name is Jim Malley; I live at 25 Tavy Bridge and maybe you share my concerns that our voices need to be heard.

If you support this project or would like to discuss it further please contact me on 020 8311 7185. We need a majority of residents to accomplish this task so please give me a call.

Jim Malley.

NOTICE BOARD

Jumble Sale date
29th June 2002, 10am – 2pm

Where?
Tavy Bridge Community Hall
(below Tavy Bridge flats).

If you would like further details you can contact Wendy Bradbury at the Community Hall on Tuesday evenings, Wednesday afternoons or Saturday evenings.



PC Rob Evans – Thamesmead Ward Officer

Photo: Thanks to *Thamesmead People*

Police surgery

PC Rob Evans will be holding a drop-in surgery every Wednesday between 2.00pm and 4.00pm at Gallions Housing Association on Harrow Manor Way. All Thamesmead residents who live in Bexley are welcome to pop in to talk to him about local safety issues, crime and to report any incidents they have witnessed.

Or you can email him on Robert.Evans@met.police.uk

Incidents can be reported in total confidence to this address.

"Being a young officer, I can understand the needs and frustrations of the youngsters of the community. I would like to let them know that I am approachable and will always find the time to speak to them and the rest of the community about anything with which they think I can help".

PC Evans is 25 and spent three years at Bexleyheath Police Station dealing with community problems within the Borough. PC Evans started his new post as Ward Officer for Thamesmead in December 2001.

Ward Officers have an 'old style beat officers' approach to their job as they have a pro-active approach in dealing with the local community and they build effective links with local people.

The key responsibilities of a Ward Officer are:

- To provide high visibility policing through foot patrols.
- To identify and liaise with victims of crime.
- To assist with Neighbourhood Watch schemes (both new and established groups).
- To undertake visits to local licensed premises and aid enquires into missing persons.
- To attend and engage in local community meetings.
- To build firm partnerships with community leaders and representatives.

PC Rob Evans can be contacted at Belvedere Police Station on 020 8283 5528 or 020 8283 5529.

CCTV is coming to Tavy Bridge!

Over the next two months, CCTV will be installed in the Tavy Bridge area.

This means that anti-social behaviour and criminal activity on Tavy Bridge will be recorded by a series of cameras. If you witness anything, please call the police or Gallions Housing Association on 0800 83 84 81 so that recorded images can be passed to the police.

Remember, you need to report incidents as soon as you can (preferably within 24 hours) for prompt action to be taken.

The CCTV recordings will help the police to take action against the small minority of people who make other people's lives a misery by persistent anti-social behaviour and criminal activity.

The installation of security cameras is in direct response to the issues raised by local residents in the survey last summer and the recent Focus Group meetings.

PC Rob Evans is delighted that CCTV will be installed at Tavy Bridge:

"CCTV will make it much easier to identify and prosecute criminals. I urge local people to use the CCTV to its full potential and to contact me if they witness any incidents on Tavy Bridge".

The CCTV equipment has been purchased by Gallions Housing Association, with assistance from the Government's Abbeywood and Thamesmead Single Regeneration Budget programme.

If you have any queries during the installation work, please contact Tony Wyatt at Gallions Housing Association on 020 8320 3484.





If you have any comments or feedback you would like include in the next newsletter, contact Kaye Sene on: 0208 320 3462. Email ksene@gallionsha.co.uk

Your views

Water Care

From a resident...



I would like to commend Mr Tom Broad and Mr Peter Coppleston of Team Gallions and their dedicated team who swiftly and sympathetically responded to my call for help in protecting the waterbirds on Gallions.

It is heartening and refreshing to find that there are still people about who soldier on, often in difficult and unpleasant circumstances to help the community... *Resident.*



This newsletter is produced by Gallions Housing Association.